

Rath RPG

Players Handbook



Erratic Eye Games

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Thank you for playing Rath RPG!

Quick Reference

Tests

d20 + stat $\geq$ DC 12. Natural 20 = crit success. Natural 1 = crit failure.

Combat Turn

Move (near) + Action, OR Run (far)

Attack

d20 + STR/DEX $\geq$ AC. Damage explodes on max roll.

At 0 HP

CON test DC 12. Pass = 1d6 HP and fight. Fail = out until danger passes.

Rest

Short (1 hr): 1d6 + CON HP. Long (8 hr): Full HP.

Leveling

Spend XP = current level. Gain aptitude at 3, 5, 7, 9.

For advanced aptitudes: See **Advanced Aptitudes** **For magic system:** See **Advanced Magic** **For GM tools:** See the **GM Handbook**

The information problem

Science fiction has fantasy’s problem in reverse: the characters have databases, sensors, and comms, and can in principle look up anything. Left alone, that dissolves improvised play the same way a phone does. The answers here are better than modern’s, because the setting hands them to you:

- **Light-lag and distance.** A query to the nearest archive takes hours or weeks. You will decide before the answer arrives.
- **The database is corporate.** It contains what someone wanted in it. The redactions are the plot.
- **Nobody has been here.** Survey and salvage games are *built* on the absence of records. The scanner tells you the mass and the temperature; it does not tell you what the thing is.
- **The sensors work fine.** They report exactly what’s there, and it makes no sense. This is the good one — trust the instruments and let the reading be the horror.

Everything else

Keep it grubby. These rules give a starting character 10 + CON hit points and no shields, which means science fiction Rath is *Alien* and *Firefly*, not *Star Wars*. The ship needs repairs, the air is a resource, and nobody is coming.

Resist the technology arms race. The weapon list above tops out at the same d10 as a greatsword on purpose — the moment a plasma rifle does d12 because it sounds like it should, the fantasy appendix stops being playable at the same table and the whole structure of this book falls over. Make advanced technology interesting through *traits* and *logistics*, never through bigger numbers.

The strangeness in a science fiction game should be genuinely strange. A xeno that’s just an orc with more arms wastes the setting. Ask what it wants, and make the answer something a human wouldn’t want.

“““”

Rath RPG Players Handbook

1. What is Rath RPG?

Rath is a rules-light fantasy roleplaying game. You play adventurers exploring dangerous places, fighting monsters, and getting into trouble. The rules stay out of your way so you can focus on what your character does, not what the rulebook allows.

The game is dangerous. Characters can die. Smart play, teamwork, and knowing when to run matter more than character builds. There are no balanced encounters—some fights are unwinnable, and that’s intentional.

Characters are simple. You’re defined by three things:

- **Stats** — Six numbers that determine what you’re good at
- **Aptitudes** — Special abilities from training or innate nature
- **Inventory** — What you carry, including equipped spells

Keywords tie your choices together. They’re narrative descriptors (Dwarf, Fighter, Sailor) that justify advantage when relevant and help define who you are in the world.

This book is fantasy, but the rules aren’t. Sections 2 through 5 don’t know what century you’re in — only the aptitude lists and the equipment do. **Appendix A** swaps those for the modern day and **Appendix B** for science fiction, and Section 7 covers running a game that uses more than one. Start here either way: fantasy is the setting these rules assume, and the easiest one to subtract from.

2. The Basics

Tests

When you attempt something uncertain with consequences, roll a **test**:

d20 + relevant stat ≥ DC

The default target is **DC 12**. Meet or beat the DC to succeed (12+ with no modifier).

- **Natural 20:** Critical success — something extra good happens
- **Natural 1:** Critical failure — something goes wrong

Most things in Rath use this same roll. Attack a goblin? d20 + STR vs its armor. Pick a lock? d20 + DEX vs DC 12. Convince a guard? d20 + CHA vs DC 12.

Variable Targets: The DC 12 default applies to general tests. Combat rolls target the enemy’s AC instead.

The Six Stats

Stat	Used For
STR	Melee attacks, lifting, breaking, physical power
DEX	Ranged attacks, dodging, climbing, sneaking
INT	Magic, resisting magic, recalling lore, crafting
WIS	Perception, tracking, navigation, finding secrets
CON	Resisting poison/sickness, added to healing and HP
CHA	Persuasion, deception, intimidation, charm

Stats typically range from 0 to 3 using the standard array, or 1 to 6 if rolling. They can reach up to 10 at high levels.

The Advantage Scale

Tests exist on a four-step scale:

Impossible → Disadvantage → Straight Roll → Advantage

Step	How to Roll	When It Applies
Impossible	Can’t attempt	No tools, no training, physically can’t be done
Disadvantage	2d20, take lower	Poor conditions, injuries, working against your nature
Straight Roll	1d20	Default for most tests
Advantage	2d20, take higher	Keywords apply, aptitudes help, favorable conditions

Moving on the Scale: - Keywords, aptitudes, good tools, and clever tactics move you **up** - Poor conditions, missing tools, and injuries move you **down** - Each factor moves you one step (a keyword moves you from straight to advantage, or from disadvantage to straight)

Stacking: Multiple factors in the same direction don’t stack beyond one step—you can’t get “double advantage.” But a factor that would grant advantage can cancel out a disadvantage, moving you back to a straight roll.

Cancellation: If you have factors pushing both up and down, they cancel one-for-one. One advantage and one disadvantage = straight roll.

Fortune Points

Fortune points let you push your luck. **Maximum 3.**

To use: After rolling any test, spend 1 Fortune to reroll and keep the higher result. You can spend Fortune on an ally’s roll if you’re in position to help—describe how.

Earning Fortune: - Start each session with 1 - Gain 1 when you roll a natural 20 - GM may award for heroic moments

Item	Cost (cr)		Item	Cost (cr)
Air, spare (UD8)	100		Mag boots	200
Comm	100		Cutting charge	400
Scanner	900		Patch kit (UD6)	80
Datapad	300		Med-injector (UD6)	150
Beacon	200		Rations (UD8)	20
Lamp	40		Sample kit	200
Multitool	60		Prybar	30
Slate, blank	30		Drone, small	1500

Writing medium and marking tool: a blank slate is both, and runs a single UD8. Aptitudes that call for them — **Scribe**, among others — are satisfied by one.

Craft

Craft	Cost (cr)	Notes
Shuttle	60000	Six passengers. Orbit to surface
Hauler	250000	Crew of four. 500 slots of cargo
Rover	20000	Surface only. Four passengers
Skiff	15000	Two passengers. In-system, short hops

B5. Optional Rules

Vacuum. No suit means a CON test DC 12 each round. Failure costs 1d6 HP and you’re unconscious on the second failure. A holed suit runs its air on a UD6 instead of a UD8, and the sound of it is the best pressure a GM has.

Low and zero gravity. In low gravity, jumps and lifts get advantage and anything requiring traction gets disadvantage. In zero gravity, you move only by pushing off something — plan your route or drift. **Void-Walker** cancels the disadvantage.

Radiation and exposure. Treat as a condition per Section 5. Severity 4-6d6 depending on source, resisted with CON, and it doesn’t stop when you leave the room.

Distance. Nothing kills a science fiction campaign faster than instant travel. Give every journey a duration in days and roll for one complication en route. A crew that can’t simply leave is a crew with problems.

Weapon	Damage	Slots	Cost (cr)	Notes
Coilgun	d8	3	1500	Far range, piercing
Scattergun	d10 / d6	3	600	d10 at close, d6 at near, nothing beyond
Pulse rifle	d6	2	1200	Far range, burst
Marksman rifle	d10	3	3000	Distant range, piercing. Setup: one round aiming, or attack at disadvantage
Cutting torch	d6	2	200	Close range. Cuts through a bulkhead given time
Shock baton	d6	1	150	Close range. CON test DC 12 or lose next action
Vibroblade	d8	2	500	Piercing

Charge packs run on a usage die — d8 for a loaded weapon, rolled once after each fight.

A note on energy weapons. They are not better than a rifle; they are a rifle with a different resupply problem. If your setting has both, let ballistics be cheap and repairable and let energy weapons recharge anywhere there's power. That trade is more interesting than a bigger die.

Armour

Armour	AC	Slots	Cost (cr)	Notes
Suit liner	+1	2	500	Worn under a vac suit
Duty armour	+2	3	1200	Disadvantage on stealth
Hardsuit	+3	5	4000	Vacuum-rated. Disadvantage on stealth and swimming
Helmet	+1	1	300	Required for vacuum
Riot shield	+1	1	400	Can be sacrificed to absorb 15 damage

Gear

Item	Cost (cr)		Item	Cost (cr)
Vac suit	800		Tether, 50 ft	30

Understanding “L”

Throughout this book, “L” means your character level.

“L times per long rest” means once at level 1, twice at level 2, and so on. “Ld6 damage” means 1d6 at level 1, 2d6 at level 2, etc.

3. Creating a Character

Here's what you'll do:

1. **Choose 2 Aptitudes** — Your special abilities
2. **Choose Keywords** — Species, role, and optionally background
3. **Assign Stats** — Distribute numbers or roll them
4. **Calculate Derived Stats** — HP, AC, and inventory slots
5. **Choose Equipment** — Pick a pack or roll for gear

That's it. You can be ready to play in ten minutes.

4. Building Your Character

Step 1: Choose Aptitudes

Choose **2 aptitudes** from the list below. These define what your character can do that others can't.

Skill Aptitudes are learned abilities—anyone can take them.

Inherent Aptitudes are innate traits that define your nature.

Your aptitude choices determine your species: - 2 Skill Aptitudes = Human - 1+ Inherent Aptitudes = Demihuman (Dwarf, Elf, Halfling, Beastfolk, etc.)

Aptitude Precedence: When an aptitude contradicts a general rule in this book, the aptitude takes precedence. Specific always beats general.

Playing modern or science fiction? Use the aptitude list in **Appendix A** or **Appendix B** instead of the one below. Everything else in this section works unchanged.

Skill Aptitudes

- **Melee Combat**
 - **Cleave:** Reduce enemy to 0 HP → free attack on another enemy in close range.

Chain until you miss, run out of targets, or reach L attacks

- **Protect:** Ally in close range hit → intercept as reaction, take the damage. With shield: CON test DC 12 for half damage
- **Resilient:** +2 HP per level. Advantage vs stunned/dazed/unconscious
- **Duelist:** Crit range 18-20. Advantage when fighting 1-on-1
- **Second Wind:** Once per short rest, action to recover $L \times 1d6$ HP
- **Berserker:** L times/long rest, rage as free action. While raging: +1 melee damage, advantage on STR tests. Ends when combat ends or you choose
- **Ranged Combat**
 - **Hawkeye:** Miss with bow → next attack has advantage
 - **Marksman:** Action to aim (give up attack) → next ranged attack has advantage + 1d6 damage
- **Assassin**
 - **Backstab:** Attack unaware target or with advantage → dagger deals extra damage dice (1 die at L1-4, 2 dice at L5-8, 3 dice at L9-10)
 - **Dagger Master:** Always have a dagger. Only dagger (no shield/other weapons): +1 AC, advantage vs larger weapons once per combat
- **Exploration**
 - **Break and Enter:** Advantage to pick locks and disable traps with thieves' tools. Complex traps/locks: roll normally. Can attempt without tools at disadvantage
 - **Move Silently and Unseen:** Advantage to sneak, hide, move quietly, remain undetected
 - **Wild Walker:** Advantage to track, hunt, forage, navigate in natural wilderness
 - **Dungeon Sense:** Advantage to detect traps, secret doors, unusual construction. Learn trap details when searching. Know depth and direction underground
- **Social**
 - **Silver Tongue:** Advantage on CHA to negotiate, improve reactions, convince (not against core interests)
- **Divine**
 - **Heal:** Once per short rest, tend creature 10 minutes → heal $(L+1)d6$ + WIS HP
 - **Turn Undead:** L times/long rest, WIS test DC 12 → undead in near range with $HD \leq 2d6 + L$ flee for 1d4 rounds
- **Magic**
 - **Hedge Magic:** Minor magical tricks. INT test DC 12 to use (failure = nothing happens, no cost).
 - **Candlelight:** Floating light illuminates close range, lasts 1 hour

Suggested Combinations

Concept	Aptitudes
Ship's pilot	Pilot + Tech
Salvage crew	Salvager + Void-Walker
Ship's doctor	Corpsman + Xenologist
Boarding marine	Marine + Athletics
Trader	Broker + Silver Tongue
Station rat	Break and Enter + Move Silently
Synthetic	Natural Armor + Tough
Contact specialist	Xenologist + Languages

B2. Keywords

Type	Examples
What you are	Human, Spacer, Heavy-Worlder, Engineered, Synthetic, Uplift, Not From Here
Role	Pilot, Medic, Marine, Engineer, Broker, Surveyor, Chaplain, Indentured
Background	Born In Transit, Corporate Contract, Colony Failed, Ex-Navy, Debt To The Company, Sole Survivor

B3. Gear Packs

All packs include a **vac suit**, a **comm**, and **2d6+5 credits**.

Pack	Contents
Deck	Suit liner (+1 AC, 2 slots), sidearm (d6, 1 slot), multitool, torch, tether
Boarding	Hardsuit (+3 AC, 5 slots), carbine (d8, 2 slots), breaching charge, tether
Survey	Suit liner (+1 AC, 2 slots), scanner, sample kit, beacon, rations (UD8)
Salvage	Suit liner (+1 AC, 2 slots), cutting torch (d6, 2 slots), prybar, patch kit, lamp

B4. Equipment

Weapons

Weapon	Damage	Slots	Cost (cr)	Notes
Sidearm	d6	1	400	Near range, concealable
Carbine	d8	2	700	Far range

- **Xenologist:** Advantage on INT/WIS tests concerning non-human life, language, and artefacts. Once per long rest, declare one true thing about a creature or artefact you’re examining
- **Corpsman:** Stabilise a dying character with no test. Once per short rest, ten minutes of care restores 1d6 + WIS HP. Works on most non-human physiologies at disadvantage
- **Marine:** No disadvantage with military weapons. Advantage on tests to hold formation, breach, or fight in low gravity
- **Salvager:** Advantage to assess wreckage, find the valuable thing in a hold, or judge whether a structure is about to fail
- **Broker:** Advantage on CHA to negotiate, appraise, or find a buyer. Once per adventure, name a contact at any station you’ve visited

Talents: **Break and Enter, Move Silently and Unseen, Silver Tongue, Athletics,** and **Languages** work as written in Appendix A.

Inherent Aptitudes

Use Section 4’s Inherent Aptitudes, read differently:

Aptitude	Reads as
Darkvision / NightVision	Ocular implant, or a species evolved somewhere dim
Natural Armor	Carapace, subdermal plating, a synthetic chassis
Natural Weapons	Claws, spurs, integrated tooling
Tough	Heavy-worlder, gene-modified, or simply built for it
Small	A low-gravity native, an engineered crew-form, a drone-body
Wings	Only meaningful in low gravity or with atmosphere — say which
Hard to Pin Down	Reflex modification

Two Skill Aptitudes means baseline human. One or more Inherent Aptitudes means you are something else — engineered, alien, augmented, or synthetic. Your keywords say which.

- **Spark:** Ignite flammables or create small flame in palm
- **Mend:** Repair small broken non-magical object (1 minute)
- **Freshen:** Clean, warm, chill, or remove odors from touched object/creature
- **Trick:** Minor sensory effect—small sound, puff of smoke, brief shimmer
- **Chartomancer:** Cast spells from scrolls. When you cast from a scroll, make an INT test DC 12 to preserve it—success means the scroll survives, failure destroys it. Advantage if INT > scroll level, disadvantage if INT < scroll level. Casting requires both hands and can be interrupted (if hit while casting, INT test DC 12 or spell fails and scroll is destroyed). Scrolls take 1 inventory slot each. Start with one level 1 scroll of your choice.

Inherent Aptitudes

These define what your character IS, not what they’ve learned.

- **Sensory**
 - **Darkvision:** See near distance in pitch darkness
 - **NightVision:** See like daytime if any light exists (starlight counts). Not in total darkness
- **Physical**
 - **Natural Weapons:** Claws, teeth, spines. 1d6 + STR damage
 - **Natural Armor:** Scales, plates, hide. +2 AC. Can’t wear manufactured armor. Can use shields
 - **Small:** Tiny (object-sized). Advantage to hide and fit through tight spaces. Ride medium creatures. -3 inventory slots (minimum 7). Weapons deal one die size smaller (d8 → d6, d6 → d4, minimum d4). **With Wings: true flight**
 - **Wings:** Glide short distances, break falls. Can’t fly alone. **With Small: true flight**
- **Combat**
 - **Tough:** Advantage on STR tests
 - **Shifty:** Larger enemy misses → force them to attack another target in range (may target self)
 - **Hard to Pin Down:** Advantage on opposed DEX tests
 - **Underfoot:** Move through spaces of larger creatures. Larger enemies have disadvantage on opportunity attacks against you

Suggested Combinations

Concept	Aptitudes	Result
Fighter	Cleave + Resilient	Tough melee combatant
Thief	Break and Enter + Move Silently	Classic rogue
Ranger	Hawkeye + Wild Walker	Wilderness archer
Cleric	Heal + Turn Undead	Divine protector
Barbarian	Berserker + Resilient	Raging warrior
Assassin	Backstab + Dagger Master	Lethal striker
Hedge Witch	Hedge Magic + Silver Tongue	Minor magic and charm
Arcanist	Chartomancer + Dungeon Sense	Scroll-casting treasure hunter
Demihuman	Aptitudes	Result
Dwarf	Darkvision + Tough	Underground survivor
Elf	NightVision + Hard to Pin Down	Graceful and elusive
Halfling	Underfoot + Shifty	Nimble and tricky
Pixie	Small + Wings	True flight, tiny
Beastfolk	Natural Weapons + Natural Armor	Claws and hide
Goblin	NightVision + Underfoot	Sneaky tunnel-dweller

Step 2: Choose Keywords

Choose 2-3 keywords that describe your character:

1. **Species** (Required): Human, Dwarf, Elf, Orc, Halfling, Construct, Pixie, etc.
2. **Role** (Required): Fighter, Thief, Wizard, Ranger, Cleric, Barbarian, etc.
3. **Background** (Optional): Noble, Outlaw, Sailor, Merchant, Soldier, etc.

Using Keywords: When a keyword is relevant, you can argue for advantage. “As a Ranger, I should have advantage tracking this beast.” If the GM agrees, you get it.

Keywords are narrative, not mechanical. They describe who you are and open doors to advantage when it makes sense.

Step 3: Assign Stats

Choose **one method**:

Method 1: Plan Ahead

Distribute these values among your six stats: **3, 2, 2, 1, 1, 0**

Put your highest number in the stat most important to your concept.

absent from them. A search that returns nothing is itself information.

The last one is the best of the four, and it’s why modern horror works: the terrifying result is the empty one.

Everything else

Modern Rath is not action-hero fiction by default. Characters have the same 10 + CON hit points as everyone else, which is two or three shots. The genre this system naturally produces is **crime, investigation, and horror** — people out of their depth in a world that mostly makes sense. Lean into that before you try to make it *Die Hard*.

Ordinary characters are the strength here. A nurse, a mechanic, and a reporter make a better party than three ex-special-forces operators, because the interesting question is what they’re willing to do, not what they’re able to.

And the world is documented, populated, and legible in a way a fantasy world isn’t — which cuts both ways. Your players know how a hospital works, so you don’t have to explain it. They also know what *should* happen when someone calls 911, which means the moment nobody comes is worth ten paragraphs of description.

Appendix B: Science Fiction

Long distances, thin air, and salvage worth more than the ship. Anywhere from a grimy near-future to the far end of a long expansion.

Currency: prices use the same numbers as Section 6. A copper piece is a **credit**; 1 sp is ten, 1 gp is a hundred.

What changes: the aptitude list below replaces Step 1’s, the keywords replace Step 2’s suggestions, and the equipment replaces Section 6’s. Sections 2 through 5 are unchanged.

B1. Aptitudes

Choose **2** at character creation, as normal.

Skill Aptitudes

- **Pilot:** Advantage on DEX tests to fly, dock, or evade in any craft you’ve been checked out on. Once per long rest, attempt a manoeuvre the GM has called impossible
- **Void-Walker:** Advantage on tests to work in vacuum, zero gravity, or a failing suit. You do not panic when the seal goes
- **Tech:** Advantage on INT tests to repair, override, or sabotage machinery and software. Identify unfamiliar equipment’s origin and condition on an INT test DC 12

Vehicle	Cost (\$)	Notes
Motorcycle	4000	Two passengers. Advantage on Driving in traffic
Van	12000	Slow. 60 slots of cargo, or six people
Boat, small	15000	

Light: a flashlight is near range and a phone screen is close range. Both run on a UD8 rolled each hour. Everything in Section 6’s Light rules otherwise applies — a modern game is not as well-lit as people assume once the power’s out.

A5. Optional Rules

Lethal firearms. The list above keeps guns level with medieval weapons, which suits pulp and horror. For a game where a gunshot is a catastrophe, shift **every** firearm up one die and give non-ballistic armour no AC against them. Apply it to the enemies too — that’s the whole point, and it makes a single hallway genuinely frightening.

Response time. Modern settings have police, ambulances, and fire crews. When something loud happens, roll a d6: that’s how many rounds until sirens are audible. This one die does more to shape modern play than any equipment rule.

Paper trails. Everything modern characters do leaves a record — cameras, card transactions, phone location. Rather than tracking it, give the GM one **Trace** token each time the party is careless. Spent later, a Trace means someone found them.

A6. Tone Notes

The information problem

This is the appendix’s central difficulty and it needs solving at your table before session one.

Fantasy runs on a small information horizon: past a day’s walk, everything is rumour, so the GM invents it and no one can check. Modern characters have a phone. Any mystery you improvise can be dissolved by a player who says “*I look it up.*”

Don’t ban the phone. Answer it. Pick whichever fits:

- **No signal.** Basements, tunnels, storms, rural dead zones, deliberate jamming. Cheap, effective, and a reason to keep moving.
- **The record is wrong.** The information exists and it’s false — the file was altered, the obituary was printed for someone still alive. Now the search is the clue.
- **Access, not knowledge.** They know the file exists. Getting it means a warrant, a favour, or a break-in. The obstacle moves from knowing to reaching.
- **It isn’t written down.** The thing they’re chasing predates records, or is deliberately

Method 2: Roll the Bones

Roll **3d6 for each stat in order** (STR, DEX, INT, WIS, CON, CHA).

The **lowest die** = that stat’s value.

When done, you may **swap any two stats**.

Step 4: Calculate Derived Stats

Stat	Formula
HP (Hit Points)	10 + CON
AC (Armor Class)	10 + DEX + armor bonus
Inventory Slots	10 + CON

Some aptitudes modify these (Resilient adds +2 HP per level, Natural Armor adds +2 AC, Small reduces inventory slots).

Step 5: Choose Equipment

Playing modern or science fiction? Use the gear packs and equipment in **Appendix A** or **Appendix B**. The slot and damage maths are the same either way.

Option A: Pick a Gear Pack

All packs include **rations (UD8)** and **2d6+5 copper pieces**.

Pack	Contents
Combat	Medium armor (+2 AC, 3 slots), standard weapon (d8, 2 slots), shield (+1 AC, 1 slot), torches
Scout	Light armor (+1 AC, 2 slots), bow (d6, 2 slots), dagger (d6, 1 slot), rope 50ft, lantern
Caster	Staff (d6, 1 slot), candles, blank book, tinderbox, lantern
Specialist	Light armor (+1 AC, 2 slots), 2 daggers (d6, 1 slot each), lockpicks, rope 50ft, grappling hook

Option B: Roll for Equipment

Weapon (choose one):

Type	Damage	Slots	Notes
Simple (dagger, club, staff)	d6	1	
Standard (sword, axe, spear)	d8	2	d10 if two-handed

Type	Damage	Slots	Notes
Two-handed (halberd, war hammer)	d10	3	Knock prone on crit
Bow	d6	2	Far range
Crossbow	d8	3	Far range, ignores 2 AC, action to reload

Armor (roll d20):

1-3	4-14	15-20
No armor	Light (+1 AC, 2 slots)	Medium (+2 AC, 3 slots)

Helmet and Shield (roll d20):

1-13	14-16	17-19	20
None	Helmet (+1 AC, 1 slot)	Shield (+1 AC, 1 slot)	Both (+2 AC, 2 slots)

Adventuring Gear: Roll twice on Dungeoneering, once on General 1, once on General 2. (See Equipment Reference at end of this book.)

Step 6: Traits (Optional)

Add personality by rolling or choosing:

d20	Physique	Speech	Virtue	Vice
1	Athletic	Blunt	Ambitious	Aggressive
2	Brawny	Booming	Cautious	Arrogant
3	Corpulent	Breathy	Courageous	Bitter
4	Delicate	Cryptic	Courteous	Cowardly
5	Gaunt	Drawling	Curious	Cruel
6	Hulking	Droning	Disciplined	Deceitful
7	Lanky	Flowery	Focused	Flippant
8	Ripped	Formal	Generous	Gluttonous
9	Rugged	Gravelly	Gregarious	Greedy
10	Scrawny	Hoarse	Honest	Irascible
11	Short	Mumbling	Honorable	Lazy
12	Sinewy	Precise	Humble	Nervous
13	Slender	Quaint	Idealistic	Prejudiced
14	Flabby	Rambling	Just	Reckless
15	Statuesque	Rapid-fire	Loyal	Rude
16	Stout	Dialect	Merciful	Suspicious
17	Tiny	Slow	Righteous	Vain
18	Towering	Squeaky	Serene	Vengeful
19	Willowy	Stuttering	Stoic	Wasteful
20	Wiry	Whispery	Tolerant	Whiny

Weapon	Damage	Slots	Cost (\$)	Notes
Suppressor	—	—	300	Adds <i>quiet</i> to one firearm. Costs one die step or one slot

Ammunition runs on a usage die like anything else — d8 for a loaded weapon, rolled once after each fight. On a natural 1 while firing, the weapon jams; clearing it takes an action.

Armour

Armour	AC	Slots	Cost (\$)	Notes
Concealed vest	+1	2	400	Hidden under clothing
Tactical vest	+2	3	800	Visible. Disadvantage on stealth
Plate carrier	+3	5	1500	Disadvantage on stealth and swimming
Riot helmet	+1	1	200	
Riot shield	+1	1	300	Can be sacrificed to absorb 15 damage

Gear

Item	Cost (Item Cost)			
Phone	300		Flashlight	20
Handcuffs	30		Multitool	40
Burner phone	20		Radio, pair	80
Zip ties (UD8)	5		Duct tape (UD6)	5
Laptop	800		First aid kit (UD6)	50
Rope, 50 ft	20		Fuel can (UD8)	30
Camera	400		Painkillers (UD6)	20
Crowbar	20		Camera, hidden	300
Voice recorder	50		Body bag	30
Bolt cutters	40		Fake ID	500
Binoculars	100		Notebook (UD6)	20
Lockpicks	100		Pens (UD8)	5

Vehicles

Vehicle	Cost (\$)	Notes
Car	8000	Distant in one round on open road. Four passengers

A2. Keywords

Type	Examples
Who you are	Human — and if not, say what. Werewolf, Revenant, Unregistered, Something Else
Role	Detective, Nurse, Priest, Soldier, Reporter, Trucker, Student, Criminal
Background	Grew Up On The Docks, Old Money, Wanted In Three Counties, Ex-Police, Burned Out, Nobody’s Left

A3. Gear Packs

All packs include a **phone**, a **wallet**, and **2d6+5 in cash**.

Pack	Contents
Badge	Concealed vest (+1 AC, 2 slots), handgun (d6, 1 slot), cuffs, radio, flashlight
Field	Tactical vest (+2 AC, 3 slots), rifle (d8, 2 slots), knife (d6, 1 slot), first aid kit, rope
Street	Knife (d6, 1 slot), lockpicks, burner phone, crowbar, flashlight
Desk	Laptop, camera, voice recorder, notebook, a car that mostly starts

A4. Equipment

Firearms

Guns do not out-damage their medieval equivalents. They out-*trait* them — a bow spends its free trait just reaching far range, while a rifle gets there and can still afford piercing or burst. Same die, three things the bow can’t do.

Weapon	Damage	Slots	Cost (\$)	Notes
Handgun	d6	1	300	Near range, concealable
Revolver	d8	2	300	Near range, reload
Rifle	d8	2	500	Far range
Hunting rifle	d8	3	600	Far range, piercing
Shotgun	d10 / d6	3	400	d10 at close, d6 at near, nothing beyond
SMG	d6	2	900	Near range, burst
Sniper rifle	d10	3	2000	Distant range, piercing. Setup: one round aiming, or attack at disadvantage

5. Playing the Game

Combat

Initiative: Each round, all PCs roll **d20 + DEX vs DC 12**.

- **Success (12+):** You act before monsters
- **Failure:** You act after monsters

Reroll each round.

Turn order: Successful PCs → Monsters → Failed PCs

Ultra-simple variant: Roll 1d6 instead. On 1-3, enemies act first. On 4-6, players act first.

On Your Turn: - **Move** up to near distance + **take an action** (attack, cast, use item, etc.) - OR **Run** up to far distance (no action)

Attacking: Roll d20 + STR (melee) or DEX (ranged) vs target’s AC. Meet or beat AC to hit.

Damage: Roll your weapon’s damage die. Add STR to melee damage.

Exploding Damage: When you roll maximum on a damage die, roll again and add. Keep rolling if you keep hitting max.

Critical Hit (Natural 20): Target loses 1 AC until combat ends.

Fumble (Natural 1): Something goes wrong—drop weapon, slip, enemy gets advantage next attack. GM decides.

Combat Maneuvers

Two Weapons: After your first attack, make a second with disadvantage.

Sacrifice Shield: Destroy your shield to absorb up to 15 damage.

Stunts: Shove, disarm, trip, etc. Resolved with opposed tests (usually STR vs STR or DEX vs DEX).

Reactions

Some abilities let you act outside your turn as a **reaction**. You get one reaction per round. Common reactions:

- **Protect** (aptitude): Intercept an attack on a nearby ally
- **Opportunity Attack:** When an enemy leaves your reach, make one free attack

Distance

Abstract	Specific	Notes
Close	5-10 ft	Melee range
Near	20-30 ft	One move, bow range
Far	40-60 ft	Running distance
Distant	60+ ft	Beyond immediate combat

Injury and Death

Dropping to 0 HP: Make a CON test DC 12. - **Success:** Adrenaline rush! Gain 1d6 HP and keep fighting. - **Failure:** Out of action. Can only crawl. Can’t act or be tended until danger passes.

When Danger Passes: Roll 2d6 on the Critical Injury Table:

2d6	Result
2-3	Dead — Make your final words count
4-6	Maimed — Permanent injury (GM determines). Gain 1d6 HP
7-9	Broken — Need 1 week bed rest. Gain 1d6 HP
10-11	Battered — Need 1 day rest. Gain 1d6 HP
12	Tough Bastard — Gain 2d6 HP, return to action!

Conditions

Hazards like poison, fire, and disease inflict **conditions**—ongoing effects that persist until cured or fought off. Your GM tracks condition severity and tells you when to roll saves or take damage. Common conditions include poisoned, burning, bleeding, and diseased.

Rest and Recovery

Short Rest (1 hour in relative safety): - Recover 1d6 + CON HP - Use abilities that recharge on short rest

Long Rest (6-8 hours of sleep in safe location): - Recover full HP - All abilities recharge - Can spend XP to level up

Advancement

Earning XP: Gain 1 XP per session where something substantial happened.

Leveling Up: Spend XP equal to your current level during a long rest. - Level 1 → 2: 1 XP - Level 2 → 3: 2 XP - Level 3 → 4: 3 XP - (and so on...)

When You Level Up:

- 1. **Increase One Stat:** +1 to any stat. No stat above 10 or above Level + 2.
- 2. **Gain Aptitude (at levels 3, 5, 7, 9):** Choose from Basic Aptitudes or ask your GM about Advanced options. Maximum 6 aptitudes total.
- 3. **Roll for HP:** Roll d8s equal to new level + CON. If higher than current max, that’s your new max. If equal or lower, add 1 to current max.

systems. Recognise malware and basic intrusions on sight

- **Streetwise:** Advantage to find black-market goods, locate criminal contacts, or read a neighbourhood’s affiliations
- **Athletics:** Advantage on STR/DEX tests for climbing, running, and moving through built environments at speed
- **Break and Enter:** Advantage to defeat locks and alarms with tools. High-security systems roll normally. Without tools, at disadvantage
- **Move Silently and Unseen:** Advantage to sneak, hide, and remain unnoticed
- **Silver Tongue:** Advantage on CHA to negotiate, de-escalate, or convince — not against someone’s core interests
- **Languages:** Two additional languages. Can be taken more than once

Inherent Aptitudes

These work exactly as in Section 4 — most modern characters take two Skill Aptitudes and are ordinary people, which is the point. Take an Inherent Aptitude only if your game has something in it that isn’t.

Use the Inherent Aptitudes from Section 4 unchanged. **Natural Weapons, Natural Armor, Darkvision,** and **Tough** describe a werewolf, a revenant, or whatever your game’s strangeness turns out to be, as well as they describe a beastfolk.

Suggested Combinations

Concept	Aptitudes
Homicide detective	Detective + Firearms
Field medic	Medic + Soldier
Getaway driver	Driving + Streetwise
Investigative journalist	Journalist + Researcher
Burglar	Break and Enter + Move Silently
Fixer	Silver Tongue + Streetwise
Hacker	Computers + Engineer
Ex-military contractor	Soldier + Athletics

Appendix A: Modern

Sirens, streetlights, and something in the storm drain. Roughly the present day — near enough that everyone at the table already knows how the world works.

Currency: prices use the same numbers as Section 6. A copper piece is a **dollar**; 1 sp is ten, 1 gp is a hundred. Call it whatever your setting calls it.

What changes: the aptitude list below replaces Step 1’s, the keywords replace Step 2’s suggestions, and the equipment replaces Section 6’s. Sections 2 through 5 are unchanged.

A1. Aptitudes

Choose 2 at character creation, as normal.

Skill Aptitudes

Occupations — what you did before this, or still do by day.

- Detective:** Advantage on tests to examine a scene, follow a paper trail, or read a suspect. Once per long rest, declare an *intuition* — the GM gives you one true fact about a current mystery
- Medic:** Stabilise a dying character with no test. Once per short rest, ten minutes of care restores 1d6 + WIS HP
- Mechanic:** Advantage on tests to repair, modify, or sabotage vehicles, electronics, and machinery. Identify the make and condition of unfamiliar equipment on an INT test DC 12
- Soldier:** No disadvantage with firearms. Advantage on tests to hold composure under fire or read a tactical situation
- Researcher:** Advantage on INT tests to recall academic knowledge in your field. Once per long rest, declare “*I studied this*” — the GM provides relevant background on a current topic
- Journalist:** Advantage on CHA tests to get information out of someone in an interview. Once per adventure, name a contact you know in your beat, and they exist
- Engineer:** Build or jury-rig a working device from what’s on hand. INT test DC 12 and ten minutes for something simple — an alarm, a signal, a shaped charge, a weapon

Talents — competencies layered onto any character.

- Driving:** Advantage on DEX tests to handle a car, bike, or boat at speed
- Firearms:** No disadvantage with handguns, rifles, and shotguns. Quick Draw works with them
- Computers:** Advantage on INT tests to use, navigate, or break into computer

6. Equipment Reference

This is the fantasy equipment list. For modern or science fiction gear, see **Appendix A** or **Appendix B** — they use the same scales, so items from any of the three can sit in the same inventory.

Currency

- Copper pieces (cp):** Common coin
- Silver pieces (sp):** 1 sp = 10 cp
- Gold pieces (gp):** 1 gp = 100 cp = 10 sp

Inventory Slots

Your inventory holds **10 + CON** slots.

Unless a table says otherwise, **an item takes 1 slot. 100 coins fill one slot.** The GM is the final arbiter on anything ambiguous.

Weapons

Weapon	Damage	Slots	Cost	Notes
Dagger	d6	1	3 cp	Throwable (near)
Club/Staff	d6	1	1 cp	
Sword/Axe/Spear	d8	2	10 cp	d10 two-handed
Two-handed	d10	3	20 cp	Prone on crit
Sling	d4	1	1 cp	Near range
Bow	d6	2	25 cp	Far range
Crossbow	d8	3	30 cp	Far, ignores 2 AC, reload

Building a Weapon

The table above is the fantasy list. The scale underneath it prices anything.

Damage	Slots	What it is
d4	1	Improvised, or a hold-out weapon
d6	1	Small, light, or one-handed
d8	2	Standard — an arming weapon or a sidearm
d10	3	Heavy, or two-handed

Every weapon gets **one trait free**. Each additional trait costs **+1 slot, or one step down the damage die**.

Trait	Effect
Ranged (near)	Attack to near distance, using DEX
Ranged (far)	Attack to far distance, using DEX
Reload	Action to reload after a set number of shots
Piercing	Ignores 2 AC
Throwable	Can be thrown to near distance
Concealable	Hidden under clothing without a test
Quiet	Doesn't give away your position on a hit
Burst	Two targets in near range, both at disadvantage

A bow checks out: d6, 2 slots, and its free trait spent on far range. So does a crossbow: d8, far range free, *piercing* paid for with the third slot, *reload* paid for by being a heavy thing to carry.

d10 is the ceiling for anything a character picks up and uses. Above it, something must pay — a round spent aiming, an ammunition limit, rarity, or an aptitude requirement. This holds across every appendix in this book; it is what lets a sword and a rifle share a table.

The GM is the final arbiter. If a player describes a weapon that isn't on any list, price it here and get on with the game.

Armor

Armor	AC Bonus	Slots	Cost	Notes
Light	+1	2	20 cp	
Medium	+2	3	60 cp	Disadvantage stealth
Heavy	+3	5	120 cp	Disadvantage stealth/swim
Shield	+1	1	10 cp	Can sacrifice for 15 DR
Helmet	+1	1	10 cp	

Usage Dice

Some supplies track depletion with usage dice:

d20 → d12 → d10 → d8 → d6 → d4 → depleted

When you use the item, roll its usage die. On 1-2, decrease die size. When d4 rolls 1-2, item is gone.

- Ammunition: Roll once after combat

Fantasy is the default for a reason

It isn't tradition. It's that fantasy characters have a **small information horizon** — everything past a day's walk is rumour, so the GM can invent it at the table and no one can check. That's what makes improvised play work, and it's the thing the other two settings have to work around rather than inherit. Each appendix says how.

Fantasy is also the superset. Hedge Magic and Chartomancy are in this book; the Circles are one supplement away. A modern or science fiction game run on these rules will have something strange in it whether you plan for it or not — and if you'd rather it didn't, ignoring the magic aptitudes costs you nothing. Start here and subtract, rather than starting elsewhere and trying to add.

Worked examples

Magic in the modern day. Run Appendix A for gear, occupations, and money. Add the Circle of Magic from *Advanced Magic* for characters who have it. Firearms and spellcasting already share a damage scale, so a pistol and a Conjure Flame sit in the same fight without anyone doing sums. The interesting question stops being *does this balance* and becomes *who knows magic is real*.

A traveller from elsewhere. The party is this book. One character is Appendix A or B — modern or far-future aptitudes, a sidearm with a hard ammunition limit, and gear nobody else can repair. The usage die is the whole story: every roll on that pistol brings them closer to being just another person in a strange place. Give them the **Stranded** keyword and let it earn advantage on knowing things and disadvantage on being trusted.

Post-apocalypse. Not an appendix at all — an assembly. Take Appendix A's gear and lethality, Appendix B's technology as ruins and salvage rather than equipment, and this book's foraging, travel, and light economy, which is the part that actually makes a wasteland feel like one. Scarcity comes free: run every consumable one usage die smaller than listed. A whole setting, and you wrote none of it.

Anything else. Weird West is this book's frontier travel with Appendix A's revolvers. Gaslamp horror is Appendix A held to this book's light rules. A generation ship is Appendix B with this book's exploration aptitudes, because a derelict deck is a dungeon. The seams are meant to be pulled at.

One thing to watch

Hold the line at **d10** for weapon damage unless something is paying for the excess. The scale in Section 6 is what keeps a sword and a rifle in the same conversation; a weapon that quietly exceeds it takes the game over. Everything else — aptitudes, keywords, gear, money — mixes freely and needs no adjudication beyond a GM saying yes.

General Gear 1 (d20)

d20	Item	d20	Item
1	Air bladder	11	Fake jewels
2	Bear trap	12	Blank book
3	Shovel	13	Card deck
4	Bellows	14	Dice set
5	Grease	15	Cook pots
6	Saw	16	Face paint
7	Bucket	17	Whistle
8	Caltrops	18	Instrument
9	Chisel	19	Quill & ink
10	Drill	20	Small bell

General Gear 2 (d20)

d20	Item	d20	Item
1	Incense	11	Fishing rod
2	Sponge	12	Marbles
3	Lens	13	Glue
4	Perfume	14	Pick
5	Horn	15	Hourglass
6	Bottle	16	Net
7	Soap	17	Tongs
8	Spyglass	18	Lockpicks
9	Tar pot	19	Metal file
10	Twine	20	Nails

7. Mixing Settings

This book is fantasy. The two appendices behind it are modern and science fiction, and they are not separate games — they are parts bins for this one.

Everything in Sections 2 through 5 is genre-blind. The stats, the DCs, the advantage scale, the damage and slot scales, the injury table: none of it knows or cares what century you’re in. Only three things change between settings — the **aptitude list**, the **keyword suggestions**, and the **equipment**. That’s what the appendices hold, and it’s why you can take from them freely without converting anything.

How to do it: decide what your game is about, then pull the pieces that serve it. Tell your players which appendices are on the table before character creation. That’s the whole procedure.

- Light sources: Roll every hour

Adventuring Gear

The common kit — what most characters buy first. Every item here is priced in this table and nowhere else in the book.

Item	Cost	Slots
Rations (UD8)	1 sp	1
Torch (UD6)	1 cp	1
Candle (UD8)	1 cp	1
Lantern	3 sp	1
Lamp Oil (UD8)	5 cp	1
Tinderbox	1 sp	1
Rope 50ft	1 sp	1
Grappling hook	1 sp	1
Thieves’ tools	1 gp	1
Crowbar	1 sp	1
Hammer + spikes	2 sp	1
Pole 10ft	5 cp	1
Steel Mirror	5 cp	-
Waterskin	5 cp	1
Scribe’s Vellum (UD6)	50 cp	1
Quill & Ink (UD8)	20 cp	1

Writing medium and marking tool: in a fantasy game these are Scribe’s Vellum and Quill & Ink. Aptitudes that need them — the **Scribe** aptitude in *Advanced Aptitudes*, for one — name the function rather than the object, so each setting supplies its own.

Tools & Gear

Everything else money can buy. Items from the kit list above are not repeated here.

Item	Price		Item	Price
Air Bladder	5 cp		Lens	1 gp
Bear Trap	2 sp		Manacles	1 sp
Bedroll	1 sp		Marbles (UD8)	5 cp
Bellows	1 sp		Metal File	5 cp
Black Grease	1 cp		Mirror (glass)	2 gp
Block and Tackle	3 sp		Musical Instrument	2 gp
Book (Blank)	3 gp		Nails (UD8)	5 cp
Book (Reading)	6 gp		Net	1 sp
Bottle/Vial	1 cp		Oilskin Bag	5 cp
Bucket	5 cp		Oilskin Trousers	1 sp
Caltrops (UD4)	1 sp		Padlock and Key	2 sp
Chain (10 ft)	1 sp		Perfume	5 sp
Chalk (UD6)	1 cp		Pick	1 sp
Chisel	5 cp		Sack	1 cp

Item	Price		Item	Price
Cookpots	1 sp		Saw	1 sp
Drill	1 sp		Shovel	1 sp
Face Paint (UD8)	1 sp		Small Bell	2 sp
Fake Jewels	5 sp		Soap	1 cp
Fishing Rod	1 sp		Spike (iron)	5 cp
Glue (UD6)	1 cp		Spike (wood)	1 cp
Hammer	1 sp		Spiked Boots	5 cp
Holy Water	3 sp		Spyglass	10 gp
Horn	1 sp		Tar (UD8)	1 sp
Hourglass	3 gp		Tent (3 man)	1 gp
Incense	1 sp		Tent (personal)	5 sp
Iron Tongs	1 sp		Twine (300 ft)	5 cp
Ladder (10 ft)	1 sp		Whistle	5 cp
Large Sponge	5 cp		Healing Potion (UD6)	5 gp

Thieves' Tools: Required for picking locks and disabling traps. Break on failed attempt by 5+.

Light

Light sources are priced under Adventuring Gear. This table is how they behave.

Item	Range	Notes
Candle (UD8)	Close	Extinguished by wind
Lantern	Near	Protected flame
Torch (UD6)	Near	Can ignite things
Lamp Oil (UD8)	—	Refills a lantern
Tinderbox	—	Lights fires

Poisons & Antitoxins

Item	Price	Notes
Antitoxin (Basic)	5 gp	Remove 2d6 from poison
Antitoxin (Superior)	20 gp	Remove 4d6 from poison
Poison, Weak	10 gp	4d6 poison
Poison, Moderate	20 gp	6d6 poison
Poison, Strong	40 gp	8d6 poison
Poison, Lethal	80 gp	10d6 poison, illegal

Warning: Requires Poison Use aptitude to apply safely. 1 dose coats weapon for 3 attacks. Illegal in most areas.

Clothing

Item	Price	Notes
Poor	1 sp	Peasant, beggar
Standard	5 sp	Traveler, merchant

Item	Price	Notes
Winter	1 gp	Protection from cold
Noble	30 gp	Access to high society
Exotic	40 gp	Foreign, eye-catching
Furs	50 gp	Luxury, warmth

Food & Lodging

Item	Price		Item	Price
Animal Feed (UD8)	4 cp		Bed, per night	1 cp
Bread, loaf	1 cp		Private room	2 cp
Cheese, 1 lb	2 cp		Hot bath	2 cp
Wine/Ale, bottle	1 cp		Stabling	2 cp
Meal	2 cp			

Animals & Transport

Item	Price	Inventory Slots
Donkey/Mule	3 gp	20 slots
Horse, riding	10 gp	10 slots
Horse, war	100 gp	10 slots
Dog, hunting	5 sp	-
Hawk	10 gp	-
Cart	5 sp	2x animal
Wagon	2 gp	3x animals
Carriage	4 gp	3x animals

Vehicles: A cart doubles the pulling animal's capacity. A wagon or carriage triples the combined capacity of two animals. Example: Two mules (20 each) pulling a wagon = 120 slots.

Random Gear Tables

Dungeoneering Gear (d20)

d20	Item	d20	Item
1	Rope 50ft	11	Lantern
2	Pulleys	12	Lamp oil
3	Candles (5)	13	Padlock
4	Chain 10ft	14	Manacles
5	Chalk (10)	15	Steel mirror
6	Crowbar	16	Pole 10ft
7	Tinderbox	17	Sack
8	Grappling hook	18	Tent
9	Hammer	19	Spikes
10	Waterskin	20	Torches